PARMAR RAILWAY

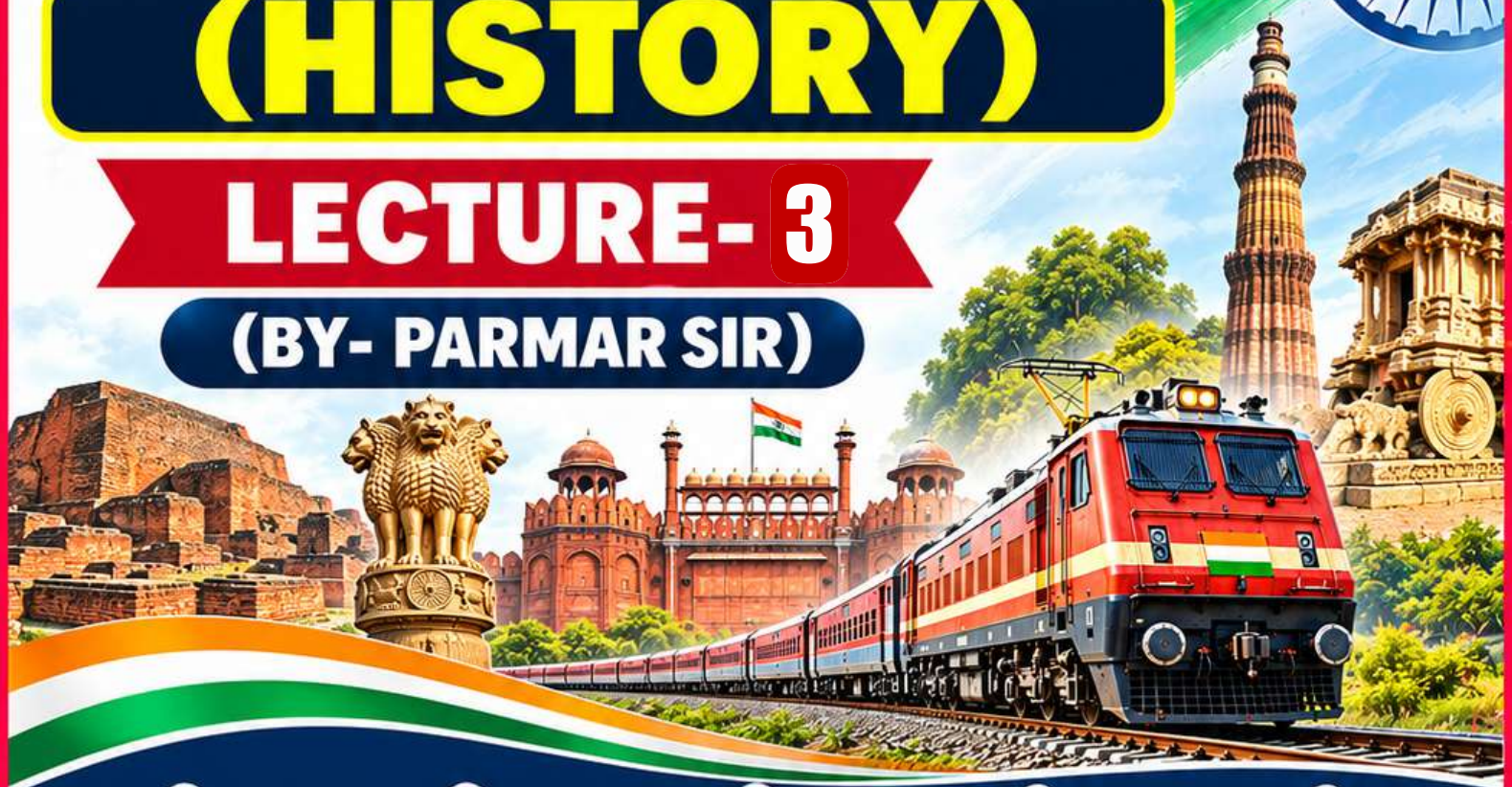
COMPLETE GK PYQ BATCH

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

(HISTORY)

LECTURE- 3

(BY- PARMAR SIR)



ANCIENT INDIA | MEDIEVAL INDIA | MODERN INDIA | FREEDOM STRUGGLE | POST INDEPENDENCE

Q.1 After the fall of the Mauryan Empire, which dynasty was founded by Pushyamitra Shunga, the general who killed the last Mauryan ruler?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (20 Aug, 2025 Shift 3))

A. Kanva Dynasty
B. Satavahana Dynasty
C. Shunga Dynasty
D. Gupta Dynasty

- Son of Pushyamitra: **Agnimitra**.
  - **Malavikagnimitra** is a love story written by **Kalidasa** about Agnimitra.
- **Patanjali** wrote the **Mahabhashya** during his time.
- Pushyamitra was a Shunga ruler, not an Indo-Greek ruler.

- **Pushyamitra Shunga** was the army general (senapati) of the last Mauryan ruler.
  - He killed the last Mauryan ruler, **Brihadratha.**
  - He then founded the **Shunga dynasty**.
- **Capital: Vidisha.**
- He followed **Brahmanism.**
- He was a devotee of **Lord Shiva.**

Q.2 The last ruler of the Shunga dynasty was:

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (23 Jun, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Agnimitra
B. Devabhuti
C. Bhagabhadra
D. Vasumitra

- **Devabhuti** was the last Shunga ruler.
- He was killed by **Vasudeva.**
- **Vasudeva** founded the **Kanva dynasty**.

Q.3 Which dynasty replaced the Shungas in Magadha?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (23 Jun, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Kushanas
B. Guptas
C. Kanvas
D. Satavahanas

- **Kushanas** were not indigenous people; they came from **Central Asia** (to be studied later).
- **Brihadratha** was the last ruler of the **Mauryan dynasty**.

- Order of rule in Magadha: **Shungas -> Kanvas -> Satavahanas.**

Q.4 King Kharavela belonged to which of the following dynasties?

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (19 Mar, 2026 Shift 2))

A. Chedi dynasty
B. Satavahana dynasty
C. Kanva dynasty
D. Shunga dynasty

- Do not confuse: the **Udayagiri caves** of **Madhya Pradesh** are different from the Udayagiri-Khandagiri caves of **Odisha.**

- **Kharavela** belonged to the **Chedi dynasty.**
- The Chedi dynasty ruled in **Odisha.**
- He built the **Udayagiri and Khandagiri caves** in **Odisha.**

Q.5 Which of the following dynasties initiated the practice of land grants to Brahmanas?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (21 Aug, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Kushanas
B. Cholas
C. Satavahanas
D. Guptas

- The **Satavahanas** started donating land to **Brahmanas.**
- Rule period: about **60 BCE to 225 CE.**
- They embraced **Brahmanism**, so they donated land to Brahmanas.
- They donated land to other sects as well.

- **Founder: Simuka.**
- **Greatest ruler: Gautamiputra Satakarni.**
- The **Puranas** mention the Satavahanas as **Andhra Bhrityas.**
- **Capital: Pratishthana (Paithan).**
- Society was **matrilineal**: rulers took their **mother's name**, not the father's (for example, Gautamiputra).

Q.6 Which of the following was the famous ruler of the Satavahana dynasty?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (20 Jun, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Kanishka
B. Vasumitra Satakarni
C. Gautamiputra Satakarni
D. Bhagabhadra

- Satavahana region: today's **Maharashtra** and **Andhra Pradesh.**
- **Ghantasala** was an ancient **port** in Andhra Pradesh under Satavahana control.

- **Gautamiputra Satakarni** was the greatest Satavahana ruler.
- The **Nasik inscription** is associated with him.
- His mother was **Gautami Balashri.**

Q.7 During the Satavahana Empire, the terms 'Ahara' or 'Rashtra' referred to:

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (08 Aug, 2025 Shift 3))

A. temple land
B. tax officer
C. Capital
D. District

- In the Satavahana empire, **Ahara** or **Rashtra** meant a **district.**
- Satavahanas started **coins made of lead and potin.**

Q.8 The Amaravati Stupa had been built by which of the following rulers?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (14 Jun, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Shungas
B. Guptas
C. Satavahana
D. Mauryas

- The **Amaravati Stupa** was built by the **Satavahanas.**
- The **Ikshvakus**, who came after them, did further work on it.
- Main material: **white limestone.**
- It belongs to the **Amaravati School of Art.**

- **School of Art** = a particular style of art (like temple styles differing in South and North India).
  - **Mathura School: red sandstone.**
  - **Indo-Greek (Gandhara) School: grey schist** (teacher also said grey sandstone).
  - **Amaravati School: white limestone.**
- **Aniconic** representation of the Buddha = non-human form (early sculptures):
  - **Empty throne / empty seat**
  - **Bodhi tree**
  - **Wheel**
- **Iconic** representation = Buddha shown in **human form.**

Q.9 The Ikshvakus ruled Krishna-Godavari delta in Eastern Deccan after the decline of which dynasty?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (17 Jun, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)))

A. Kadambas Dynasty
B. Mauryas Dynasty
C. Guptas Dynasty
D. Satavahanas Dynasty

- The **Ikshvakus** ruled the **Krishna-Godavari** delta after the **Satavahanas** declined.

Q.10 The Kadamba dynasty was founded by _____, an expert in guerrilla warfare.

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (09 May, 2026 (12:45 PM - 2:15 PM)))

A. Mahendravarman
B. Pulakesin
C. Vinayaditya
D. Mayurasarman

- **Mayurasharman** founded the **Kadamba dynasty** (Kadambas of **Banavasi**).
- **Capital: Banavasi.**
- Belief: **Pallava** soldiers insulted him, so he took revenge and **uprooted the Pallavas** from the region.

- **Mahendravarman** was a **Pallava** ruler.
- **Pulakesin** belonged to the **Chalukya dynasty**.
  - **Pulakesin II** was one of the greatest Chalukya rulers.
  - He defeated **Harshavardhana** (North India) on the banks of the **Narmada** river.
  - This is the **Battle of Narmada (614 AD).**

Q.11 Who among the following was the most celebrated Indo-Greek ruler in ancient India?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (19 Jun, 2026 (4:30 PM - 6:00 PM)))

A. Pushyamitra
B. Alexander
C. Rudradaman
D. Menander

- **Menander (Milinda)** was the most celebrated **Indo-Greek** ruler.
- **Capital: Sialkot.**
- **Milinda Panho** = questions/dialogues of Milinda.
  - Menander asked questions to the Buddhist monk **Nagasena.**

- **Indo-Greek facts:**
  - First to introduce **gold coins.**
  - Their coins carried the **portrait of the ruler**; earlier **punch-marked coins** had only symbols (trees, animals).
  - Introduced **Hellenistic art** (= Indo-Greek art), made in **grey schist**.
  - Buddha shown in a **manly form**, with baby-like hair, and **no halo.**
  - The **halo** (circle behind the head) is seen mainly in the **Mathura School.**

- **Alexander** attacked India during the time of **Dhananda** (Magadha).
  - **Magadha** was the most powerful of the **16 Mahajanapadas.**
  - Alexander actually fought **Porus**, not Dhananda: **326 BCE.**
  - He returned Porus his territory, left his military commander **Seleucus Nicator** in India, and went back.
  - Seleucus founded the **Seleucid dynasty.**
- **Rudradaman** was a **Shaka ruler.**
  - Shakas were a **Central Asian** tribe, not an original Indian dynasty.

Q.12 The Indo-Greek king who issued coins with bilingual inscriptions was:

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (19 Jun, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Antialcidas
B. Demetrius
C. Apollodotus
D. Menander I

- Coins with **bilingual inscriptions** were mainly issued by two **Indo-Greek kings; Demetrius** is the answer here.

Q.13 Which Indo-Greek ruler's envoy Heliodorus installed a pillar in Vidisha and was a devotee of Lord Krishna?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (29 Aug, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Diodotus
B. Demetrius
C. Antialkidas
D. Menander

- **Heliodorus** was the **envoy** of **Antialkidas.**
- He set up a **pillar** at **Vidisha.**
- He was a devotee of **Lord Krishna** (**Vasudeva** = Krishna; the pillar was dedicated to him).

- The **Heliodorus Pillar** is also called **Garuda Dhwaj.**
- Location: **Besnagar** (today's **Vidisha**), **Madhya Pradesh.**
- Heliodorus was a Greek who **assimilated** into Indian society.

Q.14 The Scythians, or Shakas, originally came from _____.

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (09 Jun, 2025 Shift 3))

A. Eastern Europe
B. South India
C. Central Asia
D. Southeast Asia

- **Scythians / Shakas** came from **Central Asia.**

- Order of arrival of Central Asian groups in India: **Indo-Greeks -> Shakas -> Parthians -> Kushanas.**
- All these groups **assimilated into Hindu society** and integrated with it (unlike the forceful conversions linked to Islam, as said by the teacher).
- **Satrap system** (a key term):
  - A kind of **military governorship.**
  - The military general / army head becomes the **ruler** of the area.
  - The ruler is whoever governs the place, **not** the king's son (hereditary kingship was

- **Eras:**
  - **Vikrama Samvat** began in **57 BCE.**
    - **Vikramaditya** of **Ujjain** defeated the **Shakas.**
    - The teacher referred to this Ujjain ruler as **Vikramaditya Parmar.**
  - **Shaka Samvat** began in **78 CE.**
    - It began when **Kanishka** acquired the throne.
  - Why "Shaka" era and not "Kushana" era: all foreigners coming from Central Asia were called **Shakas.**

Q.15 Which Shaka ruler is credited with repairing the Sudarshana Lake without imposing any tax?

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (27 Mar, 2026 Shift 2))

A. Kanishka
B. Rudradaman
C. Harsha
D. Nahapana

- **Rudradaman I** repaired the **Sudarshana Lake** without imposing any tax.
- Source: the **Junagadh Rock Inscription** in **Gujarat.**

- **History of Sudarshana Lake:**
  - Built (commissioned) by **Pushyagupta Vaishya** in the time of **Chandragupta Maurya.**
  - Later repaired by **Rudradaman, by Ashoka** (as said by the teacher), and by **Skandagupta (Gupta ruler).**
- **Rudradaman I** defeated the Satavahana ruler **Vashishthiputra Pulumavi.**

Q.16 The Takht-i-Bahi inscription is associated with which region?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (10 Jun, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Gujarat
B. Agra
C. Kannauj
D. Gandhara

- The **Takht-i-Bahi inscription** is from the **Gandhara** region.
- It mentions the **Parthian** ruler **Gondophernes.**
- Gandhara region = **north-western** part of the subcontinent, today **Khyber Pakhtunkhwa** (Pakistan).

- Takht-i-Bahi is included in the **UNESCO World Heritage list.**

Q.17 The title Devaputra, used by the Kushana rulers, implies which of the following?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (12 Aug, 2025 Shift 3))

A. Hereditary monarchy
B. Divine origin or claim to divinity
C. Heir to Mauryan traditions
D. Protector of Dharma

- **Devaputra = son of gods.**
- Kushana rulers claimed divine origin so that their rule would not be questioned.

- **Kushanas** came **last** among the Central Asian groups.
- Also known as the **Great Yuezhi** (teacher also said Tocharians).
- **Capitals:**
  - First: **Purushapura** (today's **Peshawar**).
  - Second: **Mathura.**
- The **Mathura School of Art** is fully **indigenous** (swadeshi); the Kushanas mainly developed it.

- **Kushana dynasties and rulers:**
  - First dynasty: **Kadphises.**
    - **Kujula Kadphises** (first ruler)
    - **Vima Kadphises** (second ruler)
  - **Kanishka** was the most important ruler.
    - He is the **3rd or 4th** ruler.
    - The **Rabatak inscription** (from **Afghanistan**) shows he was the **4th** ruler.
    - **Exam tip:** if **4th** is not in the options, tick **3rd**; if both are given, tick **4th.**

Q.18 Kanishka, the Kushana ruler, was a patron of which religion?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (06 Jun, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Buddhism
B. Christianity
C. Zoroastrianism
D. Jainism

- **Kanishka** was a patron of **Buddhism.**

Q.19 An internal trade route during the post-Mauryan empires, Uttarapatha, connected the:

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (06 Jun, 2025 Shift 3))

A. western and southern parts of India
B. southern and eastern parts of India
C. northern and southern parts of India with northwestern region
D. northern and eastern parts of India with northwestern region

- **Uttarapatha** connected the **northern and southern parts** of India with the **north-western** region.

Q.20 In which language was the Sangam literature of South India, composed between 300 BCE and 300 CE, primarily written?

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (16 Mar, 2026 Shift 1))

A. Tamil
B. Sanskrit
C. Pali
D. Prakrit

- **Sangam literature** was mainly written in the **Tamil** language.

Q.21 The term 'Sangam' refers to which of the following?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (07 Aug, 2025 Shift 1))

A. A Tamil dynasty
B. A literary assembly of Tamil scholars
C. A type of Tamil poetry
D. South Indian religious texts

- **Sangam** = an **assembly** of **Tamil poets and scholars.**
- **Period: 3rd century BCE to 3rd century CE.**
- **Total Sangams: three.**
  - **First** and **Third** Sangam: **Madurai.**
  - **Second** Sangam: **Kapatapuram.**
- All three were patronised by the **Pandyas.**
  - **Madurai** was the Pandya capital.

- **Tolkappiyam:**
  - Compiled in the **Second Sangam.**
  - Compiled by the poet **Tolkappiyar.**
  - Considered the **oldest Tamil text.**
- Texts of the other Sangams were also composed but **did not survive.**

Q.22 Which archaeological sites, besides Keeladi, have contributed to validating Sangam texts?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (15 Jun, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)))

A. Nal, Kalibangan, Mohenjo-Daro
B. Ajanta, Ellora, Hampi
C. Adichanallur, Korkai, Alangulam
D. Lothal, Dholavira, Harappa

- The Sangam Age belongs to **South India (Tamil Nadu).**
- **Adichanallur, Korkai, Alangulam** are sites in **Tamil Nadu.**
- The Harappan sites and the Ajanta-Ellora-Hampi group do not fit the Sangam Age.

- Around **1000 BCE**, while North India had **Harappan / Chalcolithic** cultures, South India had **Megaliths.**
  - **Megalith** = big stone.
  - Large stones were placed around **graves.**

Q.23 Which of the following was NOT a kingdom based on the modern-day Tamil Nadu?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (03 Sept, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Rashtrakutas
B. Chola
C. Chera
D. Pandya

- In the **Sangam Age, Cheras, Cholas** and **Pandyas** ruled in the Tamil region.
- **Rashtrakutas** were not a Tamil Nadu based kingdom.
  - **Founder: Dantidurga.**
  - **Capital: Malkhed (Manyakheta).**

- **Sangam kingdoms comparison:**

- **Cheras**
  - **Capital: Vanji** (**Karur** may appear if Vanji is not in the options).
  - **Emblem: bow and arrow.**
  - **Port: Muziris** (also called **Tondi**).
  - Mentioned in the **Ashokan inscription** as **Keralaputra.**
- **Pandyas**
  - **Capital: Madurai.**
  - **Emblem: fish.**
  - **Port: Korkai.**
- **Cholas**
  - **Initial capital: Uraiyur;** later **Thanjavur**, then **Gangaikondacholapuram.**
  - **Emblem: tiger.**
  - **Port: Puhar** (also called **Kaveripattinam**).

Q.24 Which among the following contains a collection of eight poetic anthologies from ancient Tamil literature?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (13 Jun, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Tolkappiyam
B. Pattuppattu
C. Silappatikaram
D. Ettuttokai

- **Pattuppattu** = collection of **ten** anthologies (**Pattu** = ten).
- **Tolkappiyam** is a grammar-based compilation, not the eight-anthology collection.

- **Ettuttokai** = **eight anthologies** (**Ettu** = eight, **Thokai** = anthology).

Q.25 Which aspect of life is explored under the theme of akam in Sangam literary works?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (16 Jun, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Politics
B. Deed
C. War
D. Love

- **Puram** theme = **war** and heroism.
- Memory tip: **Puram** means **fort;** forts are won by **war.** So **Puram = War, Akam = Love.**

- **Akam** theme = **love.**

Q.26 What is the main focus of the Sangam anthologies, Purananuru and Patirruppattu, from the Ettuttokai collection?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (05 Jun, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Love and emotional experiences
B. Descriptions of nature and landscapes
C. Heroism and praises of kings and their deeds
D. Spiritual and religious themes

- **Purananuru and Patirruppattu** (part of **Ettuttokai**) follow the **Puram** theme, not the **Akam** theme.
- **Puram** = heroism and praise of **kings and their deeds.**

Q.27 Which Sangam text, from the 2nd century CE, is an epic about a chaste wife's devotion?

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (22 Mar, 2026 Shift 2))

A. Pattuppattu
B. Manimekalai
C. Tolkappiyam
D. Silappatikaram

- **Tolkappiyam** is the **oldest Tamil text** (Second Sangam); **Manimekalai** is based on the daughter of Kovalan and Madhavi

- **Silappatikaram** was written by **Ilango Adigal.**
- One of the **five great epics of South India.**
- Story of **Kovalan** and **Kannagi** (husband and wife):
  - **Kovalan** fell in love with the court dancer **Madhavi** and left **Kannagi.**
  - Later Madhavi left him, and he returned to Kannagi, who accepted him.
  - Kannagi gave her **anklet** to Kovalan to sell for a living.
  - When he went to sell it, he was arrested because the **Pandya queen's** similar anklet had been lost.
  - He was **executed** on the false charge of theft.
  - Kannagi went to the court and showed her other anklet to prove his innocence.
  - She **cursed** the kingdom.
  - The **Pandya king** died of grief when he realised the mistake, and the **kingdom was destroyed.**
- Kannagi is worshipped as a **goddess of purity.**

Q.28 Manimekali, a notable work within early Tamil literature, is categorised as which type of literary composition?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (21 Aug, 2025 Shift 3))

A. An Epic
B. An Autobiography
C. A Treatise
D. A Memoir

- **Manimekalai** is an **epic**, like the **Mahabharata** and **Ramayana** of North India.
- Written by **Chathanar** (teacher: Chathuranar).
- It is about **Manimekalai**, the **daughter of Kovalan and Madhavi.**

Q.29 Who were referred to as Uzhavar in Sangam literature?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (16 Jun, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)))

A. Ploughmen
B. Large landowners
C. Slaves
D. Priests

- **Vellalar = large landowners** (rich zamindars who need not work).
- **Kadaisiyar** = agricultural labourers (teacher called them slaves).
- **Adimai = slaves** / landless labourers working in fields (teacher called them landless labourers).

- **Uzhavar = ordinary ploughmen.**

Q.30 Among which of the following powers did the 'Tripartite Struggle' take place during the 8th and 9th centuries?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (02 Sept, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Cholas, Chalukyas and Satavahanas
B. Pandyas, Pallavas and Cholas
C. Rashtrakutas, Cholas and Vardhanas
D. Palas, Pratiharas and Rashtrakutas

- Powers: **Palas, Gurjara-Pratiharas** and **Rashtrakutas.**
  - **Pratiharas: west.**
  - **Palas: east.**
  - **Rashtrakutas: south.**
- The fight was for **Kannauj.**
- Other names: **Kannauj Triangle, Kannauj Struggle;** earlier name **Kanyakubja**
- Period: **8th to late 9th century CE.**
- It lasted a long time, but no power won a **decisive victory.**

- **Why Kannauj:** it was linked with **prestige,** like **Delhi** today (a power wanting control of the country attacks the capital).
  - It was the capital of **Harshavardhana.**
- **Harshavardhana:**
  - Rule: **606 to 647 CE.**
  - Dynasty: **Pushyabhuti.**
  - Considered one of the greatest rulers of North India.
  - Wrote three plays: **Ratnavali, Priyadarshika, Nagananda.**
  - His **biography** is **Harshacharita,** written by his court poet **Banabhatta,** who also wrote **Kadambari.**

Q.31 Dharmapala, the Pala ruler, is credited with founding which of the following famous universities near Bhagalpur in Bihar?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (13 Jun, 2026 (12:45 PM - 2:15 PM)))

A. Odantapuri University
B. Nalanda University
C. Vikramashila University
D. Vallabhi University

- **Nalanda** was built by **Kumaragupta I.**
  - It was destroyed by **Bakhtiyar Khilji.**

- **Dharmapala (Pala** ruler) founded **Vikramashila University** near **Bhagalpur, Bihar.**

Q.32 During the expansion of the Gurjara-Pratihara dynasty, which of the following cities became the capital of Vatsaraja?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (09 Sept, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Ujjain
B. Mathura
C. Kannauj
D. Malwa

- **Vatsaraja's** capital was **Ujjain.**

Q.33 Who was the founder of the Gurjara - Pratihara dynasty?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (23 Jun, 2025 Shift 3))

A. Vatsaraja
B. Gopala
C. Bhoja
D. Nagabhata I

- **Nagabhata I** was a ruler of the **Gurjara-Pratihara dynasty**

- **Gopala** was the founder of the **Pala dynasty.**
  - He built **Odantapuri University.**

Q.34 In the Pallava administration, which was the smallest administrative unit directly managed by local self-governing assemblies?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (07 Aug, 2025 Shift 3))

A. Nadu
B. Mandala
C. Ur
D. Kottam

- **Ur** was the smallest unit, at the **village level,** managed by local self-governing assemblies.

- **Pallava administrative hierarchy (small to large):**
  - **Ur** (village level)
  - **Nadu** (taluk level)
  - **Kottam** (also called **Vishaya**) - governed by the **Vishayapati**
  - **Mandala**

Q.35 The five village committees (variyams) such as neernilai variyam and needhi variyam were a unique administrative feature of which of the following dynasties?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (03 Sept, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Pandyas
B. Guptas
C. Satavahanas
D. Mauryas

- **Variyams** (village committees) were a distinctive feature of the **Pandyas**.
  - **Neernilai Variyam**: managed **water / irrigation**.
  - **Needhi Variyam**: the **justice committee**, which delivered justice.

Q.36 Rajendra Chola I is known for his naval expeditions on the revived Sri Vijaya empire of:

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (09 Sept, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Indonesia
B. Myanmar
C. Sri Lanka
D. Cambodia

- **Rajendra Chola I** used a strong **navy** to conquer the **Sri Vijaya Empire**.
- Sri Vijaya was in **Indonesia**, ruled by the **Shailendra dynasty.**
- Indonesia has the **largest Muslim population** today, but once had a **Hindu** dynasty rule.

- **Rajendra Chola I:**
  - Period: **1014 to 1044 CE.**
  - Father and predecessor: **Raja Raja I (985 to 1014 CE).**
  - Contemporary of **Mahmud of Ghazni.**
  - One of the greatest **Chola** rulers.
- **Predecessor of Raja Raja I** was **Parantaka I**, defeated by Rashtrakuta ruler Krishna III.
  - Krishna III built a victory pillar, the **Krishneshwar temple at Rameswaram.**
- **Imperial (Later) Cholas:**
  - Began around the **9th century CE.**
  - **Founder: Vijayalaya Chola.**
    - Defeated the **Muttaraiyars**, feudatories of the **Pallavas.**
    - Captured the **Kaveri delta.**
    - Built a temple for goddess **Nishumbhasudini.**
  - Sangam-age Chola founder: **Karikala** (not very powerful).
- **Chola administration was decentralised:**
  - Village-level committ ees had power.
  - **Ur**: assembly of **common people.**
  - **Sabha**: assembly of **learned Brahmins.**
  - **Uttaramerur inscription** (**Chingleput** district, **Tamil Nadu**) tells about elections:
    - Names were written on **palm-leaf tickets** (pattiyal).
    - Only people with a certain **property** could stand.
    - A **boy** drew tickets **randomly** to pick the winner.
- **Land donations:**
  - To **schools: Shalabhoga**
  - To **temples: Devadana**
  - To **Brahmins: Brahmadeya**
  - To **Jain monks: Pallichchhandam**
- **Taxes:**
  - **Vetti: forced labour** (bonded labour).
  - **Kadamai: additional land tax.**

Q.37 The Periplus of the Erythraean Sea was written in the:

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (12 Jun, 2025 Shift 2))

A. 5th century AD
B. 1st century AD
C. 3rd century AD
D. 2nd century BC

- The **Periplus of the Erythraean Sea** was written in the **1st century AD.**
- The author is **not clearly known;** believed to be an **Egyptian.**

Q.38 The Chinese traveler who visited Harsha's court was:

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (23 Jun, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Hiuen Tsang
B. Hao
C. Fa-Hien
D. I-Tsing

- **Hiuen Tsang** visited **Harsha's court.**
- **Fa-Hien** came during **Chandragupta II's** time.

- **Pulakeshin II - Harsha - Pallava sequence:**
  - **Pulakeshin II (Chalukya)** defeated **Harsha** and took the title **Dakshinapatheshwara.**
  - Pulakeshin II also defeated Pallava ruler **Mahendravarman I.**
  - **Narasimhavarman I** (son of Mahendravarman I) avenged his father's defeat.
    - He defeated **Pulakeshin II.**
    - He took the title **Vatapikonda,** because the Chalukya capital was **Vatapi.**
  - Exam angle: "Who defeated Pulakeshin II?" -> **Narasimhavarman I.**

Q.39 The Chinese pilgrim Xuanzang (Hiuen Tsang) visited Kashmir during the reign of:

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (17 Jun, 2026 (4:30 PM - 6:00 PM)))

A. Yashodharman
B. Durlabhavardhana
C. Harshavardhana
D. Pulakeshin II

- **Durlabhavardhana** ruled **Kashmir,** from the **Karkota dynasty.**
- **Harshavardhana (Pushyabhuti dynasty)** ruled from **Kannauj,** not Kashmir.
- **Pulakeshin II (Chalukya dynasty)** ruled from **Vatapi** (Karnataka region), not Kashmir.
- Hiuen Tsang also visited during the time of **Harsha** and **Pulakeshin II,** but they did not rule Kashmir.

Q.40 Which Chinese traveler mentions a Maitraka ruler named Shiladitya?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (16 Jun, 2025 Shift 3))

A. I-Tsing
B. Fa-Hien
C. Hiuen Tsang
D. Faxian

- Hiuen Tsang's book: **Si-Yu-Ki (The Great Tang Records).**
- Hiuen Tsang returned to China via **Bengal.**
- **Fa-Hien (Faxian)** is the same person; he came in **Chandragupta II's time.**

- **Hiuen Tsang** (also written **Xuanzang**) mentions the **Maitraka** ruler **Shiladitya.**
- **Maitrakas:** capital **Valabhi.**
  - Maitraka ruler **Dhruvasena II** married **Harsha's daughter.**

Q.41 The Ajanta caves have been mentioned in the accounts of which of the following travellers?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (19 Jun, 2025 Shift 3))

A. Ibn-Battuta
B. Hiuen Tsang
C. Domingo Paes
D. Megasthenes

- **Hiuen Tsang's** account mentions the **Ajanta caves.**

- **Ibn Battuta: Moroccan** traveller; came during **Muhammad bin Tughluq.**
- **Megasthenes**: came to the court of **Chandragupta Maurya.**
- **Domingo Paes** and **Duarte Barbosa: Portuguese** travellers; came during **Krishnadevaraya's time.**

Q.42 The historical chronicle Rajatarangini, which presents a detailed account of the kings of Kashmir, was composed by:

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (16 Jun, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)))

A. Bilhana
B. Somadeva
C. Kalhana
D. Kshemendra

- **Rajatarangini** was written by **Kalhana.**
- It gives the **history of Kashmir.**
- Kalhana was an **author**, not a king.

Q.43 Which of the following styles of temple architecture is predominantly found in North India?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (09 Sept, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Nagara
B. Dravidian
C. Baroque
D. Vesara

- **Nagara = North Indian** temple style, developed by the **Guptas.**

- **Dravida: South Indian** style, developed by the **Pallavas.**
- **Vesara: mixture of Nagara** and **Dravida**, developed by the **Chalukyas.**
  - Examples: **Pattadakal** temples; **Aihole** and **Badami.**
- **Aihole Pillar Inscription** (also called **Prashasti**):
  - Made for Chalukya ruler **Pulakeshin II.**
  - Written by his court poet **Ravikirti.**

Q.44 Which of the following temples is an example of Dravidian architecture?

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (27 Mar, 2026 Shift 2))

A. Sun Temple, Konark
B. Kandariya Mahadeva Temple, Madhya Pradesh
C. Meenakshi Temple, Madurai
D. Lingaraja Temple, Bhubaneshwar

- **Meenakshi Temple, Madurai** is built in the **Dravidian style.**
- **Dravidian features:**
  - Has a **garbhagriha (sanctum sanctorum).**
  - The main shrine is in a **pyramidal** form, called **Vimana**, with a **Shikhara** at the top.
  - **Gopurams** (tall entrance gateways) and **Mandapas** (pillared halls).

- **Sun Temple, Konark: Kalinga** architecture (Odisha).
  - Built as a chariot (ratha) pulled by **seven horses.**
  - **Wheels** with spokes, showing **24 hours** (time).
  - The **seven horses** show the **seven colours** of sunlight (what Newton later showed by prism dispersion).
- **Kandariya Mahadeva Temple: Nagara** style, **Khajuraho** group of temples, **Madhya Pradesh.**
  - Khajuraho is known for **erotic sculptures** on the temple walls.
- **Lingaraja Temple, Bhubaneswar: Kalinga** architecture.
- **Kalinga style** (part of Nagara, found in **Odisha**):
  - Shikhara is more **straight: Rekha Deula** (Rekha Prasada).
  - **Mandapa** (pillared hall) is called **Jagamohana.**
  - **Pidha Deula**: main mandapa in **pyramidal** form.
  - **Phamsana Deula:** main temple line is slightly pyramidal.
  - **Khakhara Deula**: rectangular base with a **wagon-shaped** (barrel) roof.

Q.45 Which part of a Hindu temple serves as the innermost chamber for the primary deity?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (20 Jun, 2025 Shift 3))

A. Shikhara
B. jagati
C. Kalasha
D. Garbhagriha

- **Garbhagriha** = place where the idol of the god is installed (**sanctum sanctorum**), the innermost chamber.

- **Nagara temple parts:**
  - **Shikhara:** main tower over the garbhagriha.
  - **Amalaka:** gooseberry-shaped part on the shikhara.
  - **Kalasha:** above the amalaka.
  - **Dhwaja:** flag above the kalasha.
  - **Mandapa:** pillared hall.
    - **Mahamandapa** (big hall) and **Ardhamandapa** (half hall).
  - **Jagati: raised platform** on which the temple is built, not on level ground.

Q.46 Which of the following is a common feature of Dravidian temples?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (18 Aug, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Pillarless Hall
B. Sikhara
C. Flat Roof
D. Gopuram

- **Gopuram** is found **in South India, not** in North Indian temples.
- Difference from Nagara: in Nagara the main tower has a **curvilinear** form and is called **Shikhara;** in Dravida the main tower **is pyramidal** and called **Vimana.**

- **Gopuram** = **tall entrance gateways** of a Dravidian temple.
- Mandapas (pillared halls) are also found.

Q.47 In South Indian temple architecture, what is the name of the stepped or pyramidal structure built above the sanctum?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (05 Jun, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Adhisthana
B. Vimana
C. Jagati
D. Mandapa

- **Gajaprishtha: elliptical plan** (elephant-back shape) in South Indian temples.

- **Vimana** = stepped / **pyramidal** structure above the **garbhagriha** (sanctum).
- Jagati = raised platform in **North Indian (Nagara)** temples.

Q.48 The Pallava temples at Mahabalipuram are made mainly from:

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (18 Jun, 2026 (12:45 PM - 2:15 PM)))

A. Laterite
B. Sandstone alone
C. Marble
D. Granite

- Pallava temples at **Mahabalipuram** were made of **granite.**
- Panchratha (five rathas) were **rock-cut,** carved out of **granite rock.**

- **Pallava temple styles:**
  - **Mahendra style:** by **Mahendravarman I;** rock-cut.
  - **Mamalla style:** by **Narasimhavarman I** (also called **Mamalla**); Mahabalipuram is also called **Mamallapuram.**
    - **Panchratha** by Narasimhavarman I (rock-cut).
    - Examples: **Arjuna's Penance;** rathas such as **Draupadi Ratha** and **Bhima Ratha.**
  - **Rajasimha style: by Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha).**
    - **Shore Temples** at **Mahabalipuram.**
    - **Kailasanathar Temple** at **Kanchipuram.**
- The Pallavas developed the **South Indian (Dravida)** temple architecture.

Q.49 What is the primary material used in the 8th-century CE Kailasanatha Temple at Kanchipuram?

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (17 Mar, 2026 Shift 2))

A. Granite
B. Brick
C. Sandstone
D. Marble

- Pallavas started with **granite** temples and later developed in **sandstone**.
- **Pallava capital: Kanchipuram.**
- **Founder of the Pallavas: Simhavishnu.**

- **Kailasanatha Temple, Kanchipuram** was built of **sandstone**.
- Built by **Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha)**.

Q.50 Which temple's garbhagriha houses a Chaturmukha (four-faced) Vishnu image?

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (18 Mar, 2026 Shift 1))

A. Meenakshi Temple, Madurai
B. Brihadiswara Temple, Thanjavur
C. Dashavatara Temple, Deogarh
D. Lakshmana Temple, Khajuraho

- **Lakshmana Temple** is in the **Khajuraho** group of temples, near the **Kandariya Mahadeva Temple**.

- **Brihadeshwara temples:**
  - **Thanjavur**: built by **Raja Raja I** (also called **Rajarajeshwara**); **Chola** ruler.
  - **Gangaikondacholapuram**: built by **Rajendra Chola I**, known as the **Napoleon of South India**.
- **Airavatesvara Temple**: built by **Raja Raja II (Chola)**.
- These three are the **Great Living Chola Temples**.
- **Dashavatara Temple, Deogarh**: built by the **Gupta dynasty**.

Q.51 What type of shrine is the Neeramankara Temple located in Nemam, Kerala, in India known to be?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (10 Jun, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Sandhara type
B. Sarvatobhadra type
C. Mandapa type
D. Nirandhara type

- The temple is of the **Sandhara** type.
- **Sandhara**: has an **inner circumambulatory path** (pradakshina path) **inside** the garbhagriha.
- **Nirandhara**: has an **outer circumambulatory path outside** the garbhagriha.
- Memory tip: **inside = Sandhara, outside = Nirandhara**.

Q.52 What is a significant feature of Indian architecture related to caves?

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (25 Mar, 2026 Shift 2))

A. Influence of European architecture
B. Development of skyscrapers
C. Excavation of caves for religious purposes
D. Use of marble in construction

- Caves were excavated for **religious purposes**.
- Examples: **Kanheri, Karle, Bhaja** caves (all in **Maharashtra**).
- Made for **Buddhist monks:**
  - **Chaitya: place of worship.**
  - **Vihara: place of residence.**

Q.53 The Bhimbetka rock shelters, known for prehistoric cave paintings, are located in which of the following states of India?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (07 Aug, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Madhya Pradesh
B. Uttar Pradesh
C. Rajasthan
D. Gujarat

- **Bhimbetka** is in **Madhya Pradesh**, near **Bhopal**.

Q.54 What is the total number of cave structures at the Ajanta Caves location in Maharashtra, India, including the one that was never completed?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (21 Aug, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Thirty-two
B. Thirty
C. Twenty-nine
D. Thirty-one

- **Ellora: 34** caves; **Hindu, Buddhist and Jain.**
  - Mainly built by the **Rashtrakutas.**
- **Ajanta** credit mainly goes to the **Satavahanas** and **Vakatakas.**

- Formula: **29 + 1** (one cave was never completed) = **30.**
- Ajanta caves are **fully Buddhist.**

Q.55 'The Flying Apsara' painting is a masterpiece in which of the following caves?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (12 Jun, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Elephanta
B. Karle
C. Ajanta
D. Ellora

- The **Flying Apsara** painting is in the **Ajanta** caves.

Q.56 The Kailasa Temple at Ellora is an example of which of the following types of architecture?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (29 Aug, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Wooden architecture
B. Rock-cut architecture
C. Islamic architecture
D. Colonial architecture

- **Kailasa Temple** is **Cave No. 16** at **Ellora.**
- Built by the **Rashtrakuta** ruler **Krishna I.**
- It is rock-cut: a single rock was carved **from top to bottom.**
- Engineers still wonder how it was made with the tools of that time, and where the removed rock went.

- **Kailash of the South** (temple in the **Velliangiri** mountains)

Q.57 The famous 'Trimurti' sculpture is present in which of the following caves?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (12 Jun, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Ellora caves
B. Ajanta caves
C. Karle caves
D. Elephanta cave

- **Trimurti** is in the **Elephanta caves.**
- **Elephanta island** is near **Mumbai.**
- Associated with **Lord Shiva.**

- **Cave comparison:**
  - **Ajanta: Buddhist** only.
  - **Ellora: Hindu, Buddhist and Jain.**
  - **Elephanta: Shiva** specifically.
- **Karle, Bhaja** and **Kanheri** caves are all in **Maharashtra.**

Q.58 The 'Reclining Statue of Lord Vishnu' is found in which of the following caves?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (10 Jun, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Elephanta caves
B. Ajanta caves
C. Ellora caves
D. Undavalli caves

- **Undavalli caves** are in **Guntur, Andhra Pradesh.**
- They have **Lord Vishnu** reclining on **Sheshnag.**

Q.59 Which of the following caves are famous for its high citadel?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (18 Jun, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Sudama caves
B. Ellora caves
C. Junagadh caves
D. Bagh caves

- **Citadel** = a structure situated at a **height** (higher ground).
- It is not related to the **Indus Valley Civilisation** here.

Q.60 What is a notable characteristic of the carvings found at the entrances of the Sanchi Stupa?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (08 Aug, 2025 Shift 3))

A. Mauryan royal figures
B. Jataka story narratives
C. Buddha's post-enlightenment life
D. Mythical creatures like yakshas and kinnaras

- **Toranas** = **entrance gateways** of the stupa.
- They carry **Jataka tales** (stories of Buddha's **previous births**).

- **Sanchi Stupa** had **four gateways**, but not all were found standing; some were found fallen.
- Built in **Ashoka's** time; extended later by the **Shunga dynasty.**

Q.61 How many recognised styles of Vedic recitation (Pathas) are there?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (06 Jun, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Nine
B. Ten
C. Eleven
D. Seven

- There are **11** recognised **Vedic Pathas.**
- Two categories:
  - **Prakriti Patha: natural** / primary notes.
  - **Vikriti Patha: complex** / modified notes.

Q.62 Which of the following musical genres was considered formal and divine in ancient India?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (07 May, 2026 (12:45 PM - 2:15 PM)))

A. Gandharva
B. Dhrupad
C. Gana
D. Prabandh

- **Gandharva** music was considered **formal and divine.**
- This was taught earlier in the **Vedic** lecture.
- Source of knowledge: **Natyashastra**

Q.63 Which category of musical instruments was related to objects of utility in daily life?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (18 Jun, 2025 Shift 1))

A. Ghana Vadya
B. Sushira Vadya
C. Tata Vadya
D. Avanaddh Vadya

- **Ghana Vadya** = **solid instruments**, made from objects of daily life.
  - Examples: **thali** (plate), **ghatam** (clay pot), **sticks, bells.**

- **Sushira Vadya: wind (air) instruments**; examples: **flute (bansuri), shehnai.**
- **Tata Vadya** (also Tantu Vadya): **string instruments**; examples: **guitar, veena, sitar.**
- **Avanaddha Vadya: percussion**, with a **stretched membrane.**

Q.64 What is the name of the ancient Indian text on dramaturgy and theatre?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (09 Sept, 2025 Shift 2))

A. Arthashastra
B. Manusmriti
C. Rigveda
D. Natya Shastra

Ashtadhyayi by **Panini** (Sanskrit grammar)

- **Natyashastra** = text on **dramaturgy and theatre.**
- Known as the **Fifth Veda.**
- Compiled by **Bharata Muni.**

Q.65 Which classical Sanskrit play was written by Kalidasa?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (29 Aug, 2025 Shift 3))

A. Mudrarakshasa
B. Svapnavasavadattam
C. Abhijnana-Shakuntalam
D. Mrichchhakatika

- **Abhijnana-Shakuntalam** was written by **Kalidasa.**

- **Mudrarakshasa**: by **Vishakhadatta**.
  - It describes the **Mauryas** as a lower clan.
  - Written **much later**, not in Maurya time.
- **Mrichchhakatika (The Little Clay Cart)**: by **Shudraka.**
- **Svapnavasavadattam**: by **Bhasa.**
- **Gita Govinda**: by **Jayadeva** (Pala period).

Q.66 Which ancient Indian literary text offers detailed descriptions of statecraft, military strategy, and economic policy?

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 • 24 Mar, 2026 Shift 1)

A. Arthashastra
B. Manusmriti
C. Mudrarakshasa
D. Rajatarangini

- **Arthashastra** deals with **statecraft, military strategy and economic policy.**



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